

Edification Over Strongholds

We have been studying Romans 8:11. Ever since we discovered that Paul is not talking about the Holy Spirit in this eleventh verse, but about your born-again human spirit, this verse has opened up.

Romans 8:11 says:

"But if the Spirit of him
that raised up Jesus from the dead
dwell in you,
he that raised up Christ from the dead
shall also quicken your mortal bodies
by his Spirit that dwelleth in you."

In other words, what does the Father use to bring this life to your mortal body that condemns sin in the flesh? What does He use?

He only has one thing to use, not two. He brings life to that whole mortal body, that whole realm, by His Spirit that dwells in you. This is talking about the born-again human spirit. He does not have two things to use. He only has one.

He, the Father, brings that life to you through your born-again spirit.

As you know, the first place in Romans 8 where Paul mentions the Holy Spirit is verse 16, the very first time:

"The Spirit itself beareth witness
with our spirit,
that we are the children of God."

This time the King James separates the two for you. One is the Holy Spirit, which he identifies: "The Spirit itself beareth witness with our spirit." That is the first time in all of Romans 8 that he mentions the Holy Spirit.

The second time is verse 26, and that is why you find that little word "also" in there:

"Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities."

An infirmity here is your inability to produce results because of the limitations imposed on you by the flesh. The infirmity is that limitation, walking in the natural, walking in a natural body.

Those limitations will present themselves to you if you will take them. They are there whether you like it or not. They try to present themselves and impose themselves upon you.

Paul says:

"Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities."

Why would he say "also" if something else was not already helping them?

What helped them first? What condemned them? What does the Father use to bring life to our mortal bodies? That new nature we received. Then the Holy Ghost comes along after that.

He says, "Likewise the Holy Spirit also helps our weaknesses." When He gets involved, hallelujah, when He gets authorized to get involved, it is pretty much over.

Paul says:

"For we know not what we should pray for as we ought:
but the Spirit itself maketh intercession for us
with groanings which cannot be uttered."

When you come into the kingdom, you come in with a nature that has a capacity to be taught. You do not come into the kingdom already knowing everything. You have been translated out of darkness into the kingdom of light in His Son.

So when Paul says the Spirit also helps our weaknesses, he says it because we do not know how to pray as we ought. We did not come into the kingdom knowing everything, but we do have that capacity.

Romans 8:27 says:

"And he that searcheth the hearts
knoweth what is the mind of the Spirit,
because he maketh intercession for the saints
according to the will of God."

He who searches the hearts knows the whole mind of the Spirit. That is the whole plan of God for you, not just the seven-thousand-year plan in the mind of Christ, but the whole plan for you, your generation, your city, and your life.

That is why He is so qualified to help your weaknesses.

He who searches the hearts knows the whole plan of God, which immediately spans seven thousand years through the millennial. He not only knows that whole plan, but He knows the mind in that plan for the generation you live in, for your city, and for your life.

In particular, the Holy Spirit has all the time in eternity to represent you as an individual before the throne room of grace. This is what makes Him God. He can represent you in your different calling from mine before the throne room of grace at the same time He represents me.

"How does He do that? I have the Holy Spirit. You have Him. But if I have Him, how do you have Him? He is a person, and I have Him. He is the Spirit, and I have Him. How do you have Him?"

This is what makes Him God.

The best way to explain how He can be in you and me at the same time is, of course, that He has the attribute of being omnipresent. Jesus is omnipresent too. He is in the service whether you can feel Him or not. When He manifests Himself, you say, "Jesus showed up." Well, He was there; He just crossed over where you could feel Him.

In His omnipresence, He can be in you and He can be in me. But until you were baptized, although He was there, you did not have Him. Now that you are baptized and have received Him, you have Him.

He is here to help your weaknesses and to represent the most important thing in your life: the portion of God's overall plan that belongs to you.

If anybody else could fulfill it as well as you can, He would not use you. Where He is going to send your life, the circumstances you are trying to kill Him in, the people He has asked you to affect, and the part of the world you are going to reach: nobody could qualify for your set of circumstances like you can. That is why He is sending you.

Glory be to God.

How can He represent me? He is omnipresent, all right, but He is in me now. He is in you individually.

The best way to explain it is this: the mainframe, the seventeen-gigabyte computer, is in heaven. The mainframe is in heaven, and all of you are just little terminal PCs. Everything God is is stored in the mainframe. Every time you know something else, it is downloaded.

So you can understand how all these little PCs all over the place can be connected into one mainframe.

How do I pull a little bit of revelation out of it? You use the computer language you have been baptized in, called tongues. You send the program up, and He sends the big one back. He downloads revelation knowledge into your spirit.

Your brain is the monitor. Although you have pretty good storage capacity yourself, you can still only pull up one screen at a time. Computers are silicon-based. Your brain is carbon-based. But your spirit is spirit-based. It has incredible storage.

He has come to help your weaknesses.

Here Paul mentions an operation of the Spirit when He is moving a mountain out of your life. He says "with groanings which cannot be uttered," and he is representing the moving of a mountain. This thing is in the way of God's plan. God wants it out. Then He will move it out.

But the thing that helps Him move it out is this: once again, God does not have two things to use. In verse 11, He only has one. All life that He brings in any realm, your mortal body or anywhere, the Holy Spirit is able to do it because your spirit, the part of you that has the authority, releases Him to do it.

If He is not released by your spirit to do it, then He is literally held hostage on the inside of you.

You know that is true by preachers who lock Him up all their lives and never see a miracle, never walk in power, speak a dry tongue, and walk in the flesh. Here the Holy Ghost is wanting to do the whole work of redemption, and He is being locked up by an underfed spirit while the man works with his flesh and will not yield himself over.

This is what is so good about this supernatural language. He bypassed everything you are and went in there with permission to pray. Then the whole process of changing begins to help your weaknesses.

What the Holy Spirit does is go right to the root where all the change and power comes from. Way down there, buried in that little bitty candlelight under thirty-seven tons of flesh, He searches and barely finds one little twinkling light ready to go out. That is enough.

He can go to the light and start with the tongues, and the light starts getting brighter. If you keep it up, He will not only charge your spirit and reclaim that whole operation, He will go on to conquer your soul. When He is done with that, He starts looking around:

"Is there a city to conquer around here? A ministry to receive?"

He does not have two things to use. He says He will quicken, bring life to your mortal bodies, by that new nature He has put in you. If He cannot bring that forward, then everything God has for you and everything the Holy Spirit can do is held hostage.

We have talked about heaven enough for you to know that heaven will be full of people with no reward as a testimony to God's tender lovingkindness, grace, and mercy. He brings His children home, even if they walked in the flesh and basically served their flesh.

There is a line you cannot cross, but He will bring them home because they love Him; they just did not do much for Him.

Tender loving mercies will bring them home, and it is tremendous. After the judgment seat of Christ, when you realize what you did and His grace is applied one more time to your life, He burns up all the trash. You are saved as by fire and come out of it.

That will be one of the most horrible experiences you could imagine, to be saved as by fire. He burns everything that threw your life away. You did nothing for Him. You walked after the flesh and served money. All the trash is burned.

That is the great gnashing of teeth, wailing, and crying because there is nowhere to hide it. The secrets of the heart are made manifest. You cannot hide it. There are no secrets you can keep. There are no excuses you can make. Everything He redeemed you from will be laid on the table.

Then comes the tender lovingkindness of Jesus. He washes your tears away and brings you into a nice place in heaven. It is okay. You are home. I can take any gnashing of teeth to get there.

Let us back up a little bit to Romans 8:23. If the next time Paul mentions the Holy Spirit is verse 26, then verse 23 is still talking about which spirit? The human spirit.

Romans 8:22 says:

"For we know that the whole creation
groaneth and travaileth in pain together until now."

All creation has been subjected to corruption. She is literally pregnant with a new heaven and a new earth. She is groaning and travailing in pain until now, Paul said.

Then he separates creation from us:

"And not only they,
but ourselves also,
which have the firstfruits of the Spirit,
even we ourselves groan within ourselves,
waiting for the adoption,
to wit,
the redemption of our body."

What qualifies us for this kind of groaning? We have the firstfruits of the Spirit.

Whenever he says there is a firstfruit, that means there has to be a second. There is no use saying, "That is the first member of the choir," without going on to say, "That is the second, and that is the third."

What would the firstfruits of the Spirit be? Those of us who have been born again and received His nature have received that firstfruit.

This man could have the Holy Spirit, but in this particular case Paul is talking about the very firstfruits.

Creation is travailing in pain because of the imperfection it has been subjected to. Hebrews says the earth is going to change clothes like you would take one garment off and put another one on. We get a new heaven and a new earth that will be fitting for the creation we have become with glorified bodies.

Oh, we are going to have a good time.

But right now, my friends, you get an opportunity. You get an opportunity for reward because He left you in this body. The body is a doorway the devil can reopen if you are weak. But He left you in it and said, "I gave you My whole inheritance pertaining to the glorification of your body and a new heaven and a new earth. That is the next scheduled event that goes with the millennial. Up until that time, you have full inheritance."

In other words, all that heaven has, He made available to you if you want to go save the world.

We have an opportunity to go down in the annals of heaven as those who made a difference for all eternity. There is a reward because He gave us all the same things to do it with: a full inheritance, the mighty Holy Spirit, and a call.

No matter what our call is, one thing is sure: as you walk in it, these signs will follow. Everybody who has any call can cast out devils, speak with new tongues, and lay hands on the sick so the sick recover. Whatever else He has called us to do, those rights belong to us.

Everything that has been condemned by the new nature when we became new creations, all sickness, disease, devils, and all the authority He gave us, means every one of you is potential destruction for the other kingdom.

So He gave us all the same and pushed us out there. The next move is yours. You have the privilege of attaching yourself and tapping into what He has made you, to conquer yourself, conquer your flesh, conquer your city, and conquer the world.

You have that opportunity. You may even be met by Jesus at the gate. He may even come and get you.

"I feel weak."

You do not have to stay that way.

"I am an emotional mess."

You do not have to stay that way.

"I have been discredited."

You can be recredited. Everything but God is temporary. Circumstances are made to change.

Paul says:

"And not only they,
but ourselves also,
which have the firstfruits of the Spirit,
even we ourselves groan within ourselves,
waiting for the adoption,
to wit,
the redemption of our body."

All creation is groaning and travailing to be delivered out of corruption into the glorious liberty of the children of God. But Paul says that not only creation, but those of us who have the firstfruits of the Spirit, those who have been born again and have His nature, even we ourselves groan.

Notice where he places this kind of groaning. We groan within ourselves.

Who is doing this groaning? We are groaning within ourselves. What is causing the groaning? We are waiting for the adoption process to be made complete, and that adoption process will be completed at the redemption of our body.

Because Jesus rose from the dead, there is one glorified body put onto my account. I am told it is possible it looks better than the one I have now.

We are going to get a glorified body soon because one has been laid to our account.

When Paul says we groan within ourselves, he is talking about the nature of your new nature groaning because of all the imperfection, not only in your flesh, but surrounding you in a world gone crazy: mass murders, genocides, cults, wars, border wars. It is like it has always been.

That righteous nature, free from all those things and living in the midst of all of it, is the groaning he is talking about. We groan within ourselves, waiting for the whole adoption process to be made complete.

When will it be made complete? At the manifestation of your sonship, when you will be spirit, soul, and body.

Right now our spirit has the new nature. Our soul is being transformed. We are wearing the same kind of body we have had since the fall of man. But the next scheduled event in our sonship is that the adoption process will be made complete.

Just like the first man Adam gave you the body you are wearing and the spirit you had, the second man Adam came along and gave you the spirit you now have. Pretty soon He is also going to give you the body you will be wearing, and then you will be a full-fledged, manifested son of God with a glorified body.

When you are in heaven looking back with hindsight, you are going to thank Him and thank Him and thank Him that, in the redemption process, by man came the fall and by man came the redemption. You are going to be glad it had to come the way it did, and that you had an opportunity to take just what He gave you when He lit your candle inside of you.

He just lit your candle. But you so served Him and loved Him that you took that one little candle, and it ended up not only illuminating all that you are, but illuminating your city and touching half the world.

You are going to be so glad there was an opportunity to know Him like that. I am.

Do you want your day in court? I do.

Notice that those of us who have the firstfruit are groaning out of the new nature, waiting for the adoption process to be made complete when we get a glorified body.

When I first challenged God on this verse, I said, "I am not groaning. I am having the time of my life."

He said, "Yes, you are."

I said, "No, I would know it if I were groaning."

He said, "You are."

"No, I am not."

"Yes, you are."

Then I watched Jimmy Swaggart raising money for the first droughts in Africa some twenty years ago. He pushed a little starving child up front. I knew he was good at raising money, and I was kind of a smart aleck, so I said, "Move me, Jimmy. Move me. Go ahead, move me."

By the time he was done, my heart was up in my throat. I hurt so badly.

The Lord said to me, "You said you did not groan?"

I said, "I am beginning to understand it."

He said, "When you walk up to children in a wheelchair, how do you feel?"

I said, "I see what You are saying. You are right. I am groaning because of the imperfections imposed."

If you do not groan, if your conscience has been seared like he talks about in James, none of this stuff bothers you.

I am not talking about condemnation. I am not talking about running around in a hopeless state of agony. Where is the hope? But if this stuff does not bother you, if sin does not bother you, if lost people do not bother you, if starving children do not bother you, then one of two things is true:

either you are not saved, or your conscience has been seared and the wick on your light is very close to burning out.

Thank God for the Holy Spirit. He comes, and the only thing that qualifies Him to come is you being born again. When He comes, He goes right to the light. He uses that authority you have to begin to pray for you.

If you are not tender in your own spirit and those things do not bother you, then you will pray until your spirit becomes very sensitized.

The first thing that happens in a person who prays consistently in the Holy Ghost is that they run into themselves. So many people run away from the prayer center when they run into themselves, because there is usually nobody you like less than yourself.

Usually, when we frame people around us, what we are really attacking is ourselves. Most of the people who leave because they run into themselves have to make me wrong for what I taught, or they will be wrong.

Until you get past yourself, you are not going to get very far. Those are the first impasses, because that is where you fall out of prayer. That is usually where you go back and adopt your old lifestyle, no matter what it includes.

I do not mean here as a location; I mean this place in the Spirit.

God lives to get truth to anybody. He is no respecter of persons. Anybody can have as much of God anywhere, anytime, and He will see to it that He gets it to you. He promised:

"Blessed are they which do hunger and thirst after righteousness:
for they shall be filled."

So He comes into your spirit and begins to build you up. Usually He will wait. Your Father is so kind and full of mercy. He will usually build you above your problem.

Then what Paul was talking about comes alive: we groan within ourselves, wanting to get out of this mess, waiting for the adoption process to be made complete at the redemption of our body, waiting for all the chaos, murder, and suffering to be over.

Meanwhile, we are right in the middle of it, in a body capable of sinning and carrying strongholds.

Usually, when we build ourselves up in our spirit to where our spirit receives authority, revelation, and wisdom, and gets to discern out of the mind of Christ and see through the eyes of God, then suddenly He opens your eyes. You get to see that horrible thing you were walking in that is not conducive to the cosmos.

Right about the time He opens your eyes, you are right on the line. When He opens your eyes, you could very easily walk out of it if you chose Him and said, "No matter what happens, I will not quit edifying my spirit. I do not care what my emotions say. Everything around me is going crazy, but I

will not stop. I will not stop. I will not stop."

You build yourself above it. When you do, He opens your eyes, and you get to look at it through God's eyes. At that moment repentance will take place, because you will hate that part of your life as much as God does.

When you hate it that much, repentance takes place. You begin to groan out of your human, righteous spirit, and God says, "That is what I have been waiting for."

Then Romans 8:26 kicks in:

"Likewise the Spirit also helpeth our infirmities."

He adds Himself to our groanings, lays hold of that mountain of flesh, and moves it out of your life. The plan of God unfolds in front of you, and you are fully able to walk in the next step of what God has for you.

It is on purpose.

You pray in tongues and build your spirit above the weaknesses, flesh, habitual things, and things you used to argue to hold on to and justify. When He is able to build you above that self-justification, then He has something to work with.

If there is just one microgram of justification in you that this thing is okay, then the Holy Ghost is looking for something to hold on to. He is trying to find something to bring your victory with.

The best thing you can do is prostrate yourself on the ground and say, "I have no excuse."

You lay around justifying something, and the Holy Ghost is just trying to collect enough from you to set you free.

But the Holy Ghost has permission to build you up above that stuff.

"He that speaketh in an unknown tongue edifieth himself."

He edifies you upon your most holy faith, above a walk of sensual domination, above those who separate themselves from truth, above all of that.

Thank God for it.

Boy, did I get stuck here. I cannot help it. He does not have two things to use. He only has one. Even when the Holy Ghost creates that prayer for you, He has to transfer it to your spirit, because God only has one thing to use: your spirit.

When you build yourself up above that walk of sin and suddenly look at it through God's eyes, through the tender loving mercies and grace of God and how much He loves you, you see it and say, "Oh my God. I was horrible, was I not?"

He will say, "Yes. But when you loved it, what did I have to work with? What did I have to work with when you justified it, walked in it, and loved it? What did I have?"

Now that you have built yourself above it and are groaning out of your righteous spirit to be free of it, the Holy Ghost picks up on your groaning and adds His groaning. He who searches the heart knows the plan of God and makes intercession for you according to His will.

Likewise, the Spirit helps our weaknesses. We do not know how to pray as we ought. He says, "Excuse Me," and He picks up with your groanings in the language that cannot be uttered, searches the heart, knows the plan of God, and moves that stuff out of your life so you can walk on with what He has for you in His mind.

Now you know you are getting free.

You love God, and all of a sudden you start hating whatever it is in you that is keeping children in wheelchairs. You start hating it so badly that you are groaning out of your righteous spirit. All you can do is fast and pray about it. You hurt so badly over it you cannot stand it.

Then the Holy Spirit picks up on that groaning, adds His power, moves the mountain out of the way, and you just might receive the workings of miracles. You will quit having to run into those kids in wheelchairs and leave them in them.

Is this not wonderful? Hallelujah.

Second Corinthians 5 is saying the same thing:

"For we know that if our earthly house
of this tabernacle were dissolved,
we have a building of God,
an house not made with hands,
eternal in the heavens."

Paul says:

"For in this we groan,
earnestly desiring to be clothed upon
with our house which is from heaven."

Meanwhile, He has given us the earnest of the Spirit.

Here in Romans 8 He says He saved us in hope. In 2 Corinthians 5 He says He gave us the earnest of the Spirit. Hope of what? A glorified body. He saved us in hope of a glorified body.

He gave us the earnest of the Spirit, and in Romans 8:26 He tells how the earnest of the Spirit helps us while we are in these bodies.

Paul has chapter after chapter on this. I do not isolate just one. My God, it has to be the truth. That is what makes it work.

Hallelujah. I feel so good I cannot stand it. Conquer my body and all kinds of things. I do not have to carry a doctor with me when I go overseas. I do not have to beg for money.

Is this not glorious? Do you not just love Him? Do you love edification?

Hallelujah. I do.

Back up to Romans 8:11 again:

"But if the Spirit of him
that raised up Jesus from the dead
dwell in you,
he that raised up Christ from the dead
shall also quicken your mortal bodies
by his Spirit that dwelleth in you."

He will move that power, that new nature, take the authority that is in you, and use it to bring life to your mortal body by His Spirit that dwells in you.

That is why verse 12 says:

"Therefore, brethren,
we are debtors,
not to the flesh,
to live after the flesh."

We are debtors no more to the flesh. Any operation of the flesh, habitual sickness and disease included, is an operation of the flesh. He canceled all those debts. He canceled them by the law of the Spirit of life, which is that new nature.

Therefore, brethren, we are debtors not to live after anything the flesh wants to bring. He canceled that debt by that new nature when you and I were born again.

But remember, He does not have two things to use. He only has one thing. The Holy Ghost cannot even kick Himself into operation until you let Him by your spirit.

You might get healed by somebody else's faith. The Holy Ghost is able to do wonderful things for you by somebody else, or by an operation of God's mercy or grace. But the area I am talking about, canceling debt, is after you have been prayed for and healed, when you are out on the job by yourself and the devil comes back and says, "You were not really healed."

In the next few days we find out whether the debt is canceled by your spirit. I am talking about walking there.

I have arrived at a place of peace I have never walked in before, and I have been talking about it, wearing you out. But all it is is another place in the Spirit where the Holy Ghost was loosed to quicken a whole part of my life and ministry I had never walked in before.

When the devil swung his left hook, I had so much joy and peace that I came under condemnation because of my peace.

How are you going to help anybody by being part of the defeat and lying around bawling? Hallelujah.

You have the Holy Spirit living in you. If you are not there yet, He will say, "Work with Me, and you will get there." And you will.

Glory be to God.

Then when you add fasting, my God. Hallelujah.

My faith was one degree off until I realized in this chapter that God only had one thing to use: my born-again spirit. I was one degree off because I kept trying to get the Holy Spirit to do the things His Word said He was supposed to do, but I did not give Him any authority to do it with.

I wish faith were a switch you turned on with your brain. You can start it there. Your confession can say, "I have faith in God. If You said this, it is true." You will begin to build yourself to what does flip the switch.

Sometimes you hardly know when the switch goes on. The old-timers used to call it "praying through." They would stay on their face until they got that inner witness, that prayed-through feeling. Then they would get up and say, "It is done." And it would be, because they knew by that inner witness when the switch went on.

Sometimes we do not know. We walk the floor and confess, building ourselves up in that realm of the Spirit. All of a sudden, He crosses a line and it happens. The Holy Ghost says, "Oh, look, he crossed the line. We can do it. We can do it," and He goes and does it.

Do you think there is anything too hard for Him?

Do you feel like a victorious person sitting there just waiting to conquer something?

If the Spirit of Him, the Spirit of Him, what spirit is that? The Spirit of Him that raised Christ from the dead.

I was going to take you to this point because I had plenty of time when I started, but then I got over into an area of edification you probably needed.

Stay in there. You cannot turn the switch of faith on with your brain. Your brain can supply information for the part of you that does turn it on. I wish you could, but you cannot.

Now I have learned through communion with Him that there is a place in Him where my spirit is in communion. When I walk up to something that needs to be healed, about eight out of ten times now, I just reach out with my faith and He is right there. That electricity starts flowing. Even before I get up there, God, it feels good.

Hallelujah.

We have two minutes to go to John for the Spirit of Him. This is the part I have been wanting to get to.

John 5:25 says:

"Verily, verily, I say unto you,
The hour is coming,
and now is,
when the dead shall hear
the voice of the Son of God:
and they that hear shall live."

The hour is coming and now is, because Jesus is on the earth and the hour has arrived. One hour in the millennial time clock is forty-one years.

The dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God. Do you wonder about, "My sheep know My voice, and another they will not follow"? You are connected to Him with a new nature. That is what He was talking about.

Notice what He says. The hour is coming and now is when the dead shall hear the voice of the Son of God. This is not just the dead hanging around Abraham's bosom according to His promise to Abraham, because the Firstborn had not been born yet.

Jesus had a new nature, but His new nature did not go from death to life, and the law that brings yours from death to life did not exist until His spirit went from death to life. There was no law in the earth to bring yours from death to life until then:

"For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus
hath made me free
from the law of sin and death."

So when He speaks of the dead, He is talking both on top of the ground and under the ground, because everybody was dead. They hear the voice of the Son of God, and they that hear shall live.

Then He gives you the reason they will live in verse 26:

"For as the Father hath life in himself;
so hath he given to the Son
to have life in himself."

The Father had life in Himself. He gave to the Son to have life within Himself, and the Son turned around and gave you the same life that the Father handed to Him.

So if the Spirit of Him that raised Christ from the dead dwells in you, He that raised Christ from the dead by that life He put in Jesus and in you will use that new life to bring life in every realm of your mortal body. He will quicken you, destroy disease, and destroy sin. All you have to do is turn Him loose.

The same Spirit of Him.

I can tell you that Jesus Christ, as God, created everything that exists and consists. Even after Jesus was quickened, He is the One who hands the life on to everybody else. It is the Spirit that is of Him.

There is only one time the Father stepped in, in all creation, to birth something. Jesus could not birth Himself and still be His own Son.

All things were by Him, through Him, and consist by Him: Jesus, known as the second Person of the Godhead, the mighty Logos. Thrones, principalities, things to come, angels, even Adam's creation, all of it was Jesus.

Only one time in all creation did the creation have to go around Him to the Father. That was when the Father reached inside Himself and pulled out the life that caused Him to become His Son. Then He handed that life on.

And the life it will hold is good. It is plenty.